Chapter 2

Control Your Apps with Rails

The biggest benefit of using Hotwire Native to build mobile apps is that you are rendering content directly from the Rails server. Make a change to your Rails code, and boom—the iOS and Android apps get that update automatically. But it can be hard to appreciate that magic until you see it for yourself.

This chapter covers different techniques and approaches to drive content and behavior in the apps directly from the server. Everything in this chapter will be Ruby on Rails code.

Specifically, you'll learn how to do the following:

1. Dynamically set a native title via HTML.
2. Hide the navigation bar with conditional Ruby.
3. Hide the navigation bar with CSS.
4. Add back in missing elements.
5. Keep users signed in between app launches.
6. Access the user's Camera and Photos on iOS.
7. Access the user's Camera and Photos on Android.

But before we explore each technique, I want to show you something—probably the most exciting part about building Hotwire Native apps.

First, visit `https://localhost:3000` in your browser and open Xcode to run the iOS app. Both show the hike index page as expected.